Barnabus!

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BDT 2002 · Marbella · Featuring Boysie, Hursty & Robbo

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale

A memory explaining why Boysie responds to the name "Barnabus".... (as well as Brian)!

Location: Palms Beach Bar, Marbella Port.

Weather: Stinking Hot

Time: Circa 3pm, Tuesday 3 September 2002, the first full day of the Inaugural Tour

To set the scene, the inaugural tourists had risen from their slumbers at around 2.30pm after what was supposed to have been a "quiet night".



The scene of Barnabus!

We decided to head into Marbella Old Town to broaden our horizons, get a feel of the place, see the sights, mix with the locals, that sort of thing.

Robbo, our man with the local knowledge, steered a slightly circuitous route, which by pure chance took us past a little beach bar called “Palms”. The phrase "how's about we have a cheeky quiet one here just to settle the nerves" was muttered by The Monkey, I seem to recall.

After our first round of Stella Miguels, and then a second, third and fourth, the stories started coming out as usual. Hursty asked Robbo if he knew anybody in Marbella, to which

Robbo replied: "No, not really". Then the next 2 rounds of Stella Miguels arrived free from people who knew Robbo who happened to be sitting at the bar, to which Hursty remarked: "I think I like this place!". Before we knew it we were in the midst of a Leo Sayer.

Robbo seemed delighted that his numerous lines on BT had not been heard before by Langers No Wangers, and so his full repertoire came out, to the amusement of everyone.

All the while, Boysie had been keeping his own counsel, happily soaking up a few rays and enjoying the banter. The topic of conversation turned to: "What is the worst job you have ever had". I had recently nearly killed a fellow employee when rocketing a bag of shoe uppers down a 40 foot high chute at Newman's Shoe Factory, so I feel fairly certain that I introduced this particular topic.

Cue Boysie:



BOYSIE

"I recall Graham (Boysie's dad) telling me that I needed to toughen up a bit, experience the real world and mix with the working class, before I settled into my prosperous career as a solicitor. Before I knew it, Graham had fixed me up with a position, and I was striding into a local car mechanics with a copy of The Times tucked under my arm and perhaps, one might say, not quite dressed appropriately for the occasion.

I was greeted curtly by three shaven-headed, tattooed chaps, who glanced up from their copies of the Daily Sport and looked me up and down in a way that suggested we were never going to become close pals.

> After a very brief interrogation, I was led by one of the said skinheads into a back office, and handed a mop and bucket: "The garage floor needs a bloody good clean. But you can start with the downstairs toilet."
>
> Now I was not quite sure what I had expected when I pitched up for a role at a car mechanics, but needless to say it wasn't necessarily to be mopping floors, and certainly not cleaning up fresh faeces. However, eager to make a good impression on my new colleagues I headed off, mop and bucket in hand, to the downstairs toilet, which I subsequently found to be a generous description of the place where these chaps tended to p!ss and sh!t without any real concern as to whether they were hitting the pan or not. To add to my joy, as I reached the toilet the door swung open and by far the largest, fattest one of the skinheads came out proudly saying: "foooking hell lad, you might want to give that a minute!"
>
> At this point I was angrily questioning the wisdom of Graham's decision but, reluctantly, I carried on with my cleaning duties and generally tried to keep a low profile. However, by lunchtime on the first day, it became apparent that I had acquired a new name:
>
> Barnabus.
>
> Apparently because I was posh."

At this point Boysie did try to continue with his story, but was unable to do so, as one or two of us were actually crying. The name Barnabus has never been the same since.



Barney Dog Spots